
End-of-Year Full-Body In- ventory

Close the year with an honest look at where your
body actually is

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

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HEALING HANDS BY NATE

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Between Sessions Bonus — Month 12
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Introduction

A BETWEEN SESSIONS BONUS PROTOCOL FOR closing the year with a clear-eyed look at where you actually are.

We're closing the year. I want you to take ten minutes and actually check in with your body — not how you think you feel, but how you actually feel, area by area.

Most people end the year on autopilot. December is busy. The body just keeps doing what it does. You arrive at January 1st with a vague sense of “another year” and no specific information about what your body actually needs in the coming year.

This inventory changes that. Ten minutes, once a year, to do an honest scan. Where do you hurt? Where are you stiff? Where did you make progress this year? What needs attention next year?

You don't need any equipment. Just this workbook, a pen, and 10 minutes of quiet.

CHAPTER 1

Why this matters

WITHOUT AN END-OF-YEAR INVENTORY, MOST people make resolutions that have nothing to do with what their body is actually telling them. “I should exercise more.” “I should stretch more.” “I should take better care of myself.” Vague, untargeted, abandoned by February.

With an inventory, you have specific data. You know which three areas are loudest. You know what got better this year and what got worse. You know what to actually focus on in the new year — not what you think you should focus on, what your body is telling you to focus on.

That’s the difference between January resolutions that fail and a body-care priority that actually holds through the year.

CHAPTER 2

The 10-minute inventory — area by area

FOR EACH AREA, DO THE SAME THREE STEPS:

- 1. Move through its full range of motion** — slowly, with attention
- 2. Rate pain right now** (0 = none, 10 = severe)
- 3. Rate mobility right now** (0 = can't move it, 10 = full normal range)

Then take note: is this area better than January, worse than January, or about the same?

Feet

Stand. Lift one foot off the floor. Circle the ankle 5 times each direction. Point and flex 5 times. Switch feet.

How did that feel? Any pain? Stiffness? Clicking?

Right foot: Pain [] / **Mobility** [] / Compared to January: [] better / [] worse / [] same **Left foot:** Pain [] / **Mobility** [] / Compared to January: [] better / [] worse / [] same

Knees

Stand normally. Squat down as far as comfortable. Stand back up. Now do a slow lunge — right foot forward, left knee down toward the floor. Switch sides.

Any pain? Catching? “Giving way” feeling?

Right knee: Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same **Left knee:** Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same

Hips

Standing on one leg (use a wall for balance), make big slow circles with the other hip. 5 each direction. Switch.

Tight? Restricted? Painful in any range?

Right hip: Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same **Left hip:** Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same

Low back

Stand tall. Slowly arch backward as far as comfortable. Slowly round forward as far as comfortable. Slowly twist right, then left.

Where’s the restriction? Where’s the pain?

Low back: Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same

Mid-back

Cross your arms over your chest. Without moving your hips, rotate slowly to the right as far as you can. Then to the left. Try to arch backward gently — feel where the bend happens.

Mid-back: Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same

Shoulders

Arms out to the sides. Make big slow circles forward, then backward, 5 each direction. Then reach one arm overhead, lean to the opposite side. Switch sides. Now reach behind your back with each hand — can you touch your fingers between your shoulder blades?

Right shoulder: Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same **Left shoulder:** Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same

Neck

Slow rotations both directions. Ear-to-shoulder tilts both sides. Chin to chest. Gentle look up (don't crank).

Pain? Restriction? Headaches associated with the neck?

Neck: Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January:
☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same

Jaw

Open your mouth slowly as wide as comfortable. Side to side. Forward.

Clenching? Clicking? Soreness in the masseter?

Jaw: Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐
better / ☐ worse / ☐ same

Hands

Make tight fists. Open and spread fingers wide. Wrist circles both directions.

Grip strength? Stiffness? Old injuries acting up?

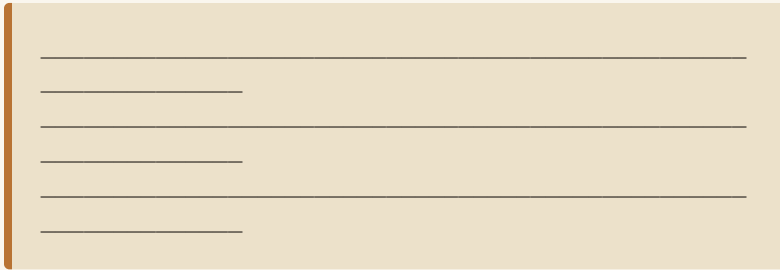
Right hand: Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same **Left hand:**
Pain ☐ / **Mobility** ☐ / Compared to January: ☐ better / ☐ worse / ☐ same

CHAPTER 3

Tally the results

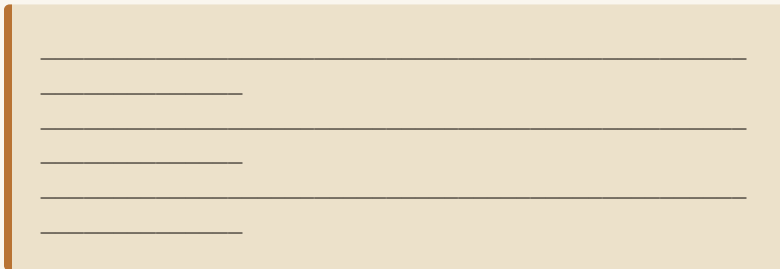
LOOK BACK AT YOUR SCORES. THREE QUESTIONS to answer honestly:

1. What got better this year?



Don't skip this. The improvements deserve naming. They're proof that the work — whatever work you did — actually moves things.

2. What got worse this year?



This is the data that points to next year’s focus. Things that got worse without a specific injury are usually cumulative-load problems that need attention you haven’t been giving them.

3. What stayed the same that shouldn’t have?

This is the most important question. If something has been the same for a year — same pain, same stiffness, same restriction — and you haven’t done anything specific to address it, it’s not going to fix itself. It needs a deliberate intervention next year.

CHAPTER 4

Pick your three priorities

NOW THE MOST IMPORTANT STEP: NAME THE three areas that need attention next year.

Not five. Not ten. Three.

Priority 1:

Why:

Priority 2:

Why:

Priority 3:

Why:

Three priorities is what your nervous system can actually track and work on. More than three and the focus dilutes.

CHAPTER 5

Write it down where you'll see it

TAKE THESE THREE PRIORITIES AND PUT THEM somewhere you'll see them in January:

- Bathroom mirror
- Bedroom wall
- Kitchen fridge
- Inside the cover of your planner
- Phone wallpaper

When January 1st comes around and you're tempted to make vague resolutions, you'll see your three actual priorities staring back at you. That's your real plan.

CHAPTER 6

When to come see me

IF YOUR INVENTORY REVEALED AN AREA THAT'S been the same for a year (or worse), schedule a session in January. Don't wait for spring. The new year is when nervous-system pattern interruption works best — your body is more open to new inputs after the holiday reset.

If the inventory showed mostly improvement, congratulations. Maintenance is half the battle. Keep doing whatever you've been doing.

CHAPTER 7

Closing

WRITE DOWN YOUR THREE PRIORITIES. PUT IT somewhere you'll see it in January. That's your roadmap for next year. You know your body better than anyone — you just proved it.

Most people end the year without ever asking their body these questions. The bodies that get better over time are the bodies whose owners actually check in. You just did.

See you on the table in the new year.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
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